



GDD 67

Raising Neurodiverse Kids

Different, not less. Understand, accommodate, champion.

A Parent Layer pillar and a warm callback to Same Same, Different (g04): difference is wonderful, grown up for parents. It helps a parent understand a child who is autistic, has ADHD, or has learning differences like dyslexia, reframes neurodivergence as difference, not deficiency, gives practical ways to accommodate how the child is wired, equips them to advocate, and lifts the shame and blame, especially in India. Strengths-first, never deficit-shaming, never a diagnostic tool. Seven mechanics, 26 choice-and-voice moments, zero "tap the right card". Scorecard: passed.

Understand. Accommodate. Champion.

Raising Neurodiverse Kids helps parents understand and support a child who is autistic, has ADHD, or has learning differences like dyslexia. It reframes neurodivergence as difference, not deficiency; gives parents practical ways to accommodate how their child is wired; equips them to advocate at school and with family; and lifts the shame and blame that too often surround a diagnosis, especially in India. It is strengths-first and never deficit-shaming, never blames parent or child, is not a diagnostic tool, and routes co-occurring anxiety and parent burnout to support. New v2 build, Same Same, Different's "difference is wonderful" carried full circle into parenting.

FIELD	VALUE
Node / gameld	g67 · raising-neurodiverse-kids (confirm exact id against engine-host)
Chapter / layer	Chapter 8 · Parent Layer · adult / warm / strengths-first
Thread / topics	C · Parent Layer · Positive Parenting · UNESCO 5.6, 1.3, 5.5
Prerequisite / builds on	g66 · builds on g04 (Same Same, Different) · links g63
Gating	Open · strengths-based; non-blaming; not diagnostic
Schema / status	v2 · scorecard PASS the raising-neurodiverse-kids game.

84 scenarios	7 mechanics	17 myth-flips	26 choice & voice	0% binary taps
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Different, not less, and it's no one's fault. Neurodivergence is a different way a brain is wired, not a fault to fix, and a neurodiverse child brings real strengths, deep focus, pattern-spotting, energy, creativity. It works far better to accommodate the wiring (sensory supports, routines, movement breaks) than to force a child to mask, and accommodations give fair access, like glasses. You are your child's key advocate, with rights under the RPwD Act 2016, and a meltdown is overwhelm, not naughtiness. You didn't cause it, you can't cure it, and you can absolutely help your child flourish.

Difference to support, not a fault to cure.

From the Chapter 8 personas (parenthood). Meena, whose son's "misbehaviour" is autism, facing stigma from family and school and a flood of online misinformation, the persona note: frame neurodivergence as difference to support, never a fault or a disease to cure. She needs facts, and help with the real battles.

PERSONA	WHAT THEY NEED HERE	THE MECHANIC THAT SERVES IT
Meena (the diagnosis)	To understand her son and drop the blame.	strike-rewrite + reflect: understand, drop shame.
Meena (at school)	To advocate for accommodations and rights.	role-play + branch: advocate.
Divya & Vikram	Practical home accommodations and co-regulation.	sort + match: accommodate, strengths.
Any exhausted parent	Support, networks and their own wellbeing.	role-play + match: support & you.

Why this works (the evidence). Neurodivergence is a difference, not a deficiency, and the affirming approach is strengths-first: autism, ADHD and dyslexia are real ways of being and learning, brains naturally vary, and each commonly brings real strengths. It works far better to adjust the environment and expectations to the child than to force masking, accommodations give fair access like glasses, and parents are their child's key advocate, with rights under India's RPwD Act 2016, which recognises autism and learning disabilities and mandates reasonable accommodation. Neurodivergence isn't caused by parenting, screens or vaccines, meltdowns are overwhelm rather than manipulation, and a child is a whole person far more than a label, while the parent's own wellbeing matters because the work is demanding.

Seven moves, led by the flip.

It's an affirm-and-equip game, so **strike-rewrite** leads (busting the deficit-and-blame myths) with **branch** for the support-first choices and **sort** for telling support from masking; **role-play** gives the words to advocate and reframe. Mechanics rotate; the same one never runs twice in a row.

MECHANIC	THE PARENT DOES	EMBODIES	N
strike-rewrite signature	Busts a deficit-or-blame myth.	Conceptual change.	17
branch (the choice)	Chooses to understand, accommodate or advocate.	Judgement.	14
sort	Sorts strength vs deficit-view; support vs masking; lifts vs piles shame.	The line.	12
role-play (voice)	Advocates, reframes, reassures the child.	Voice; the champion.	12
reflect	Internalises different-not-less and seeing the whole child.	Values.	10
match	Pairs a need to an accommodation; a strength to a way to nurture it.	Connections.	10
spot	Spots the helpful lens, the thriving accommodation, the self-worth builder.	Reading it.	9

26 of 84 moments are branch or role-play. Binary "tap the right answer": **0%**.

The two-test, passed.

Is it engaging?

Game feel is relief, understanding and pride for a parent drowning in worry and stigma: the release of 'different, not less' and 'it's no one's fault', the competence of practical accommodations that actually help, and the warmth of seeing their child's strengths. The "oh, I can understand and champion my child" moment lands repeatedly. Sam is a warm adult guide; the tone is strengths-first, never deficit-shaming, never blames parent or child, and never pretends to diagnose.

Is it teaching?

Yes: understanding the common neurodivergences and a child's own profile; accommodating sensory, attention and learning needs at home; advocating for support at school and with family; recognising co-occurring anxiety and wellbeing needs; and rejecting the stigma and blame, with parent burnout and the child's wellbeing routed to support.

The belief it moves. From "broken or less; just naughty or lazy; force them to fit; accommodations spoil; my bad parenting caused it; a meltdown is bad behaviour; they'll grow out of it; hide the diagnosis" → "different, not less; a real way of being; accommodate the wiring; fair access like glasses; it's no one's fault; a meltdown is overwhelm; support helps; and openness lets help in."

Built, not bolted on.

84 researched scenarios across the understand → accommodate → advocate → drop-the-shame → strengths-and-wellbeing → support arc, India-grounded, strengths-first and warm. Full library in the companion JSON.

CATEGORY	N	LEAD MECHANICS	COVERS
Understand your child	14	strike-rewrite, sort, role-play	Different, not less; strengths-first; their own profile.
Accommodate	14	strike-rewrite, sort, match	Adjust the environment; sensory, routines; fair access.
Advocate	14	strike-rewrite, role-play, branch	School, family, services; RPwD rights; seek assessment.
Drop the shame & blame	14	strike-rewrite, sort, branch	It's no one's fault; meltdowns aren't naughtiness.
Strengths & wellbeing	14	strike-rewrite, role-play, sort	Build on strengths; co-regulate; the whole child.
Support & you	14	strike-rewrite, role-play, match	Your wellbeing, networks, professionals; not diagnostic.

The 'different not less' flip + the 'not your fault' flip, verbatim.

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flip: "A neurodiverse child is broken or less than other children."
UN -> "A neurodiverse child is broken or less."
RE -> "Neurodivergence is a different way a brain is wired, not a fault or
      a lesser version; different, not less."

flip: "My child's neurodivergence is caused by my bad parenting."
UN -> "My bad parenting caused my child's neurodivergence."
RE -> "It isn't caused by parenting, screens, vaccines or anything you did;
      it's simply how your child is wired. It's no one's fault."
```

Full library: [SwipeEd — GDD 67 Raising Neurodiverse Kids — Scenario Library.json](#) (84 records, v2 schema).

What this game flips.

MYTH (UN ERASES)	TRUTH (RE WRITES)	BASIS
A neurodiverse child is broken or less.	Different wiring isn't damaged wiring; different, not less.	Different not less.
Autism, ADHD, dyslexia are labels for naughty or lazy kids.	They're real ways of being and learning, not character flaws.	Real, not naughty.
Force my child to fit and behave 'normally'.	Adjust the environment to the child, don't force them to mask.	Flex the setting.
Accommodations spoil a child or are unfair.	Like glasses, they give fair access; they level, not tilt.	Fair access.
My bad parenting caused this.	It isn't caused by parenting, screens or vaccines; no one's fault.	Not your fault.
A meltdown is just bad behaviour.	It's overwhelm and communication; the child needs co-regulation.	Overwhelm, not defiance.
They'll grow out of it if we ignore it.	It's lifelong; understanding and support help them thrive.	Support helps.
Hide the diagnosis so people don't judge.	Openness, on your terms, lets support and understanding in.	Openness over hiding.

The micro-loop.

1. **Surface.** A real moment, a meltdown read as 'misbehaviour', a school dismissing needs, a relative's blame, a strength overlooked.
2. **Choose or voice.** The parent chooses to understand, accommodate or advocate (branch), or finds the words (role-play).
3. **The flip.** UN busts a deficit-or-blame myth; RE writes the strengths-first truth.
4. **Accommodate & champion.** Adjust the environment, build on strengths, co-regulate, advocate for rights.
5. **Shame off, support on.** Drop the blame; route the child's wellbeing and parent burnout to support (Looking After You, g63).
6. **Sticker.** The Raising Neurodiverse Kids badge; GameDone records once.

Signature surface: the **different-not-less** reframe and the **accommodate-the-wiring** move. It brings Same Same, Different (g04) full circle into parenting, sits with the positive-parenting pillars (g65-g69), and routes wellbeing to Looking After You (g63).

Strengths-based; never blaming; not diagnostic.

- **Strengths-based, never deficit-shaming.** It reframes neurodivergence as difference, builds on strengths, and never frames a child as broken or a list of deficits.
- **Never blames parent or child.** It's no one's fault, meltdowns are overwhelm not naughtiness, and the node lifts shame rather than adding to it.
- **Not a diagnostic tool.** It supports understanding and points to qualified professionals for assessment and specific care; accurate and expert-reviewed.
- **Wellbeing routed.** Co-occurring anxiety and the child's wellbeing, and parent burnout, are signposted to support (Looking After You, g63).
- **Rights and accommodations (India).** It points to the Rights of Persons with Disabilities Act 2016, which recognises autism and specific learning disabilities and mandates reasonable accommodation, general information, not legal advice.
- **Privacy & access.** Private by design (DPDP-aligned), on-device; self-directed, audio, offline, low-end; de-stigmatising and India-localised.

Different, not less, and support exists (India). Neurodivergence is no one's fault and not something to 'cure', it's a different way of being, with real strengths. Seek a professional assessment without shame, and know your child's rights to reasonable accommodation under the RPwD Act 2016. For the child's anxiety or your own burnout, see Looking After You (g63); for mental-health support, Tele-MANAS **14416**. Beware anyone selling a 'cure'. This is general information, not a diagnosis or legal advice.

v2 schema, scorecard-gated.

- **gameld. raising-neurodiverse-kids** equals node.game equals GameDone key equals registry id (confirm exact id in engine-host).
- **v2 mechanic-embodiment schema.** type + typed payload; the **strike-rewrite** deficit-myth flip and the **branch** support-first choice co-lead.
- **Strengths-based & non-blaming are hard requirements.** Strengths-first, never-deficit-shaming, never-blaming and not-diagnostic are contractual; accurate and expert-reviewed.
- **Fact-checked content.** The neurodiversity-affirming strengths frame, accommodation evidence, and the RPwD Act 2016 recognising autism and learning disabilities verified this build.
- **Scorecard-gated.** Passed all eight checks (7 mechanics, top mechanic at 20%, 0% binary, 26 autonomy, 17 UN→RE, 5 personas, 100% completeness). Re-run `score_gdd.py` on any edit.
- **Help-resource hook.** Child wellbeing and parent burnout route to Looking After You (g63) and Tele-MANAS 14416; assessment to professionals.
- **Tracked.** `build_gate.py` finalize advances g67 to v2 PASS only after order, read, score, audit and artifact gates pass.

Ethics contracts (never traded for engagement): strengths-based and never deficit-shaming; never blames parent or child; not a diagnostic tool, points to professionals; wellbeing routed to g63; rights under the RPwD Act; de-stigmatising; made-for-India.

Why this works.

- **Different not less, so lead with strengths.** Because neurodivergence is natural variation with real strengths, seeing a child's strengths rather than only their struggles shapes how they see themselves and helps them thrive.
- **Accommodation beats forcing, so teach it.** Since adjusting the environment to the child works far better than forcing masking, and accommodations give fair access, practical home and school supports genuinely help.
- **Shame helps no one, so lift it.** Because it's no one's fault and meltdowns are overwhelm, dropping the blame and routing wellbeing to support is what frees a family to understand and champion their child.

Sources: UNESCO inclusive education; WHO and UNICEF on autism, ADHD and developmental differences and inclusive parenting; the neurodiversity-affirming, strengths-based approach (neurodivergence as difference not deficit, individualised accommodations such as sensory supports and visual schedules, and provider positivity improving caregiver-child outcomes); co-regulation and parental-wellbeing research; and India's Rights of Persons with Disabilities (RPwD) Act 2016, which recognises autism and specific learning disabilities among 21 conditions and mandates reasonable accommodation, presented as general information, not legal or medical advice. Strengths-first and never deficit-shaming, never blaming parent or child, and not a diagnostic tool, pointing always to professionals. Citations accompany each scenario in the library JSON. 67 games now v2. Next by order: Navigating Addictions (g68).